NIGRAH

A Financial Threat Intelligence System for Investor Resilience

(Working Name: NIGRAH. We don't need a forced acronym right now. Strong names do not always need expansion.)

Context Draft v1.0

The Problem Nobody Is Solving

India's investor ecosystem has expanded rapidly, particularly across Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities. Millions of first-time investors now participate in financial markets through mobile phones, social media, messaging platforms, online advisors, and digital communities. Yet while access to investing has grown, access to trustworthy intelligence has not. The result is a widening gap between participation and protection.

Today, most investor-protection systems operate after harm has already occurred.

A scam emerges.

Victims lose money.

Complaints are filed.

Authorities investigate.

Warnings are issued.

Knowledge arrives after the loss.

The fundamental problem is not the absence of warnings. The fundamental problem is **information delay**.

The Information Delay Hypothesis

Every financial scam leaves signals before it creates victims.

Before money is lost, there is usually:

- A message
- A promise
- A social media campaign
- A fake authority claim
- A website
- A Telegram group
- A YouTube channel
- A manipulated narrative

- A pressure tactic

The signals appear before the damage.

However, these signals remain fragmented across thousands of public sources.

No system currently converts those signals into actionable investor intelligence at scale.

A New Perspective

Most existing solutions attempt to answer:

"Is this particular message a scam?"

NIGRAH asks a different question:

"What patterns consistently appear before investor fraud succeeds?"

This shifts the problem from content moderation to threat intelligence.

A scam is not merely a fraudulent message.

A scam is a collection of behavioural manipulation patterns.

The wording changes.

The platform changes.

The scammer changes.

The psychological mechanisms remain remarkably consistent.

SEBI's own investor awareness material repeatedly highlights recurring red flags such as guaranteed returns, fake expertise, urgency, high-pressure tactics, misleading authority claims, social-media promotion, and lack of transparency.

The Core Idea

NIGRAH proposes the creation of India's first Financial Threat Intelligence Layer.

Instead of collecting information about victims, NIGRAH collects information about scam behaviour.

The system continuously analyzes publicly available signals from:

- SEBI alerts and enforcement actions
- Regulatory advisories
- Public scam reports
- Financial news
- Public social media content
- Public websites
- Public investment communities

The objective is not surveillance.

The objective is pattern extraction.

From Scams to Threat Families

Today, scams are treated as isolated events.

NIGRAH treats scams as members of larger threat families.

For example:

- Guaranteed Return Fraud
- Fake Advisor Fraud
- Telegram Signal Fraud
- Pump-and-Dump Networks
- Deepfake Finfluencer Campaigns
- Fake Trading App Ecosystems
- Ponzi Variants
- Authority-Impersonation Fraud

SEBI's investor alerts already reveal that many scams follow recurring stages and repeatable structures, including fake experts, guaranteed returns, exclusivity claims, social proof, referral incentives, and withdrawal restrictions.

Rather than storing individual incidents, NIGRAH seeks to map these recurring structures.

The Intelligence Layer

The central belief behind NIGRAH is simple:

Scams evolve faster than rules, but slower than human psychology.

A fraudster may change:

- The app
- The group name
- The website
- The branding
- The language

But the underlying manipulation strategy often remains the same.

If these manipulation strategies can be identified, measured, and modeled, then emerging scams can be compared against known threat families before widespread damage occurs.

Vision

NIGRAH is not a scam-reporting portal.

It is not an investment advisory tool.

It is not a trading product.

NIGRAH is a public-good intelligence system that transforms fragmented public information into structured financial threat intelligence.

Its purpose is to reduce information delay between the emergence of a financial threat and the awareness of investors.

In the long term, NIGRAH aims to create a continuously evolving map of India's financial scam ecosystem, enabling earlier detection, better investor awareness, stronger resilience, and more informed public protection.

NIGRAH Threat Signal Framework (TSF v1)

Foundational Principle

Every financial scam can be decomposed into a combination of measurable threat signals.

Instead of asking:

Is this a scam?

NIGRAH asks:

Which manipulation signals are present?

The combination of signals determines:

- Manipulation Pattern
- Scam Family
- Threat Index
- Investor Risk Score

Tier 1 Signals

These are the highest-confidence signals repeatedly identified by regulators.

TS-01

Guaranteed Return Signal

Examples:

- Guaranteed profit

- Assured return
- Fixed monthly return
- Risk-free investment

Appears in:

- Ponzi schemes
- Fake advisors
- Telegram scams
- Fake PMS scams

Weight: 10/10

Regulators consistently identify guaranteed returns as one of the strongest fraud indicators.

TS-02

Unrealistic Return Signal

Examples:

- 10% weekly return
- Double money
- 5x in 30 days

Weight: 10/10

TS-03

Fake Authority Signal

Examples:

- SEBI expert
- Market guru
- Certified analyst
- Insider expert

Weight: 9/10

TS-04

Impersonation Signal

Examples:

- Fake broker

- Fake advisor
- Fake institution
- Similar brand identity

Weight: 10/10

TS-05

Unregistered Entity Signal

Examples:

- Unregistered advisor
- Unknown platform
- Unknown PMS provider

Weight: 10/10

Tier 2 Signals

These signals indicate active manipulation.

TS-06

Urgency Signal

Examples:

- Last chance
- Join today
- Only 2 hours left
- Market opening soon

Weight: 8/10

TS-07

Scarcity Signal

Examples:

- Limited seats

- VIP slots
- Invite only

Weight: 7/10

TS-08

FOMO Signal

Examples:

- Next multibagger
- Don't miss this
- Everyone is buying

Weight: 8/10

TS-09

Social Proof Signal

Examples:

- Profit screenshots
- Testimonials
- Success stories

Weight: 8/10

TS-10

Community Pressure Signal

Examples:

- Telegram groups
- VIP groups
- Inner circle

Weight: 7/10

Tier 3 Signals

These create trust and emotional attachment.

TS-11

Trust Building Signal

Examples:

- Daily interaction
- Personalized guidance
- Friendly mentor

Weight: 6/10

TS-12

Exclusivity Signal

Examples:

- Secret strategy
- Insider access
- Premium circle

Weight: 7/10

TS-13

Reciprocity Signal

Examples:

- Free tip
- Free stock
- Free course

Weight: 5/10

Common persuasion mechanism in fraud literature.

TS-14

Lifestyle Projection Signal

Examples:

- Luxury cars
- Dubai lifestyle
- Rich trader image

Weight: 6/10

Tier 4 Signals

These appear during scam execution.

TS-15

Payment Diversion Signal

Examples:

- Personal account transfer
- Third-party payment

Weight: 10/10

TS-16

Withdrawal Restriction Signal

Examples:

- Processing fee required
- Tax before withdrawal

Weight: 10/10

TS-17

Escalating Investment Signal

Examples:

- Invest more

- Upgrade plan
- Increase capital

Weight: 9/10

TS-18

Borrow-To-Invest Signal

Examples:

- Take loan
- Use leverage
- Borrow funds

Weight: 9/10

Tier 5 Signals

Information quality signals.

TS-19

Non-Transparent Signal

Examples:

- Hidden strategy
- No documentation
- Vague explanation

Weight: 8/10

TS-20

Complexity Shield Signal

Examples:

- Too technical to explain
- Proprietary AI strategy
- Secret algorithm

Weight: 7/10

TS-21

Rumor-Based Signal

Examples:

- Insider news
- Secret information
- Hidden source

Weight: 8/10

TS-22

Unsolicited Contact Signal

Examples:

- Random call
- Random SMS
- Random WhatsApp

Weight: 8/10

Tier 6 Emerging Signals

Future-proof category.

TS-23

Deepfake Authority Signal

AI-generated experts.

Weight: 9/10

TS-24

Fake Trading App Signal

Weight: 10/10

TS-25

Referral Pyramid Signal

Weight: 8/10